



AFTER

While many labeled Brown a fanatic or a lunatic, others—both in the North and the South—cherished his memory, albeit for widely differing motives.

FREE BLACK AMERICANS PREPARE

After decades of ineffectual talk, a white abolitionist had finally joined hands with Black men to **attack slavery on its home soil**. In the North, free Black Americans organized military companies in cities such as Philadelphia, Boston, New York, and Pittsburgh. **Brown was lionized**, becoming a potent symbol and subject of a popular song on the lips of **Black soldiers** when they **joined the Union army** in 1863 (see [Routine work](#)).

BOOST TO THE CAUSE OF SECESSION

Fears of slave revolts wracked the South throughout 1860. Those intent on secession used Brown's raid as a warning of the horrors of insurrection. One such advocate, Edmund Ruffin of Virginia, went to great lengths to keep the memory of the raid alive. He asked officials at Harpers Ferry to send him the pikes seized after the raid, labeled them "**Samples of the favors designed for us by our Northern Brethren**," and sent one to each Southern governor.